

YASH AGGARWAL, *24*

Restaurateur, ***Delhi***

Dream fulfilled: **Went skydiving in Dubai**

How Covid changed me

"When my father got sick with Covid, I saw how quickly life can change. I decided I won't be afraid to do things I want to do. The pandemic taught me courage"

"THE FOCUS IS ON FINDING ONE'S INNER SELF, BUILDING ON RELATIONSHIPS THAT MATTER, GENERALLY LIVING IN THE MOMENT"

RUCHI SHARMA, *Clinical psychologist, Manipal Hospitals, Delhi*

supply was disrupted too. That led the couple from flower to root, in a manner of speaking. On September 10, 2021, they opened the Orchids Jungle Camp, a boutique homestay and resort, at Kondegaon Village, on the fringes of the Tadoba Andhari Tiger Reserve in Maharashtra.

"On a trip to Tadoba in 2007, we had fallen in love with the place and dreamed of having a home here. We planned for it too, consistently," recalls Prabhjoth. But the idea remained on the backburner for over a decade. After Covid, however, the Arvals sold their home in a gated community in Hyderabad, and invested in a four-acre site at Kondegaon village, on the fringes of the tiger reserve. "It is so satisfying... the thought that we could follow our dream and bring it to fruition," says Srikanth.

The road to change need not be a solitary one. In Kolkata, three friends found inspiration and strength in one another to change their professional destinies. Paromita Banerjee, 53 and a single mother, could never have imagined quitting her job earlier—but Covid brought her closer to her real self. "I was good at art and craft. When I thought of picking up a calling that would make me happy at the end of the day, it had to be art," she says. In February, Banerjee launched Mohona, an outlet for handloom and handicrafts. She says she would not have ventured to take this career risk had it not been for her friend Sunita Lahiri, who had also left her job as a top HR person in PricewaterhouseCoopers.